GFH 1000 In Dialogue with Humanity

Guidelines and Questions for Oral Presentation

2024-25, Term 1

Dr. Deng Yangzhou

Instructions:

1) Suppose you are an online instructor of classic texts in humanity, and your audience consist of high school students or laypersons in the relevant areas, give a recorded free-style presentation on one of the given topics.

2) Since your audience have no special knowledge of the topics, you should try to make your speech as friendly and jargon-free as much. Normally, it should contain at least one concrete example illustrating the abstract theme. Likewise, your audience are too young and too uneducated to tolerate long speeches, so ideally your presentation should last no more than 5 minutes, and a talk longer than 6 minutes is not acceptable.

3) Save your talk from Zoom into a MP4-format video file, and submit it as an attached file before the first tutorial on the text (specifically, before 10:30 AM on Monday).

4) The relevant text of presentation should not be in the same part for which you are to write a Reflective Journal from.

Topics:

-- Part I –

1）Symposium

(1) Explain the Socratic Method to your audience, using one example from the text, and one conceived by yourself.

2）Ethics

(1) Explain the meaning of Aristotle's "Eudemonia" with examples, and explain why for Aristotle it is the highest good in human life.

3) Analects

(1) Explaining the relation between *Li* (礼) and *Ren* （仁） and present the debate between Confucius and Zai Wo (宰我) (*Analects* 17.21) as well as your opinion on the debate.

(2) Explaining the relation between *Xiao* (孝) and *Ren* （仁） and present the debate between Confucius and Ye Gong (叶公) (*Analects* 17.13) as well as your opinion on the debate.

4) Zhuangzi

(1) Explain Zhuangzi's notion of "Useless Use" (无用之用) embodied in the text of "*Xiao Yao You*".

(2) Explain the story of "Zhuangzi's Transformation into Butterfly" (庄周化蝶) in accordance with the central theme of "*Qi Wu Lun*".

-- Part II –

5) Heart Sutra

(1) Use examples to explain the Buddhist notion of "One is All" (一花一世界) in accordance with your understanding of the Sutra.

(2) Explain the meaning of "Emptiness" (空) in the Sutra, with sufficient illustrative examples.

6) Bible

(1) Give an account of Jesus' systematic conflictions against the "old tradition" and explain the reason behind such conflictions.

(2) Give an explanation of Jesus' "Commandment of Love", and further introduce how he himself practices love to people.

7) Quran

(1) Explain your understanding of the role of female Muslims in the context of the "Cow".

(2) Make a study of the Islamic concept of "Polytheism" (以物配主) and explain the attitude against Polytheism in the "Cow".

-- Part III –

8) Waiting for the Dawn

(1) Explain Huang's conception of an ideal prince (贤君), and your comments on such a conception.

9) Social Contract

(1) Explain the concept of "General Will" with example(s).

(2) Explain the role of the Legislator in Rousseau's thought, and explain why there should be such a legislator in his idea.

10) Wealth of Nations

(1) Use examples to explain the notion of "Invisible Hand".

11) 1844 Manuscripts

(1) Illustrate Marx's notion of "Estrangement of Labour" in a contemporary context.